

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

heavier. Fear of being judged for our actions with money can keep us paralyzed and unable to make decisions, while past instances of being judged or criticized can echo in our minds, cancelling out any and all positive feedback.

I'm going to let you in on a secret, though. You don't have to allow other people's judgements and opinions of you to affect you. They can knock on the door, they can huff and puff, but you do not have to let them in. Especially if those judgements come from people who don't really know you, or who have a completely different experience of life from you. You get to decide whose opinion matters to you, and whose advice you listen to – everything else is just superfluous, and you can learn to tune it out.

When I started to open up about my own relationship with money and the mistakes I'd made, I knew that I would be faced with other people's opinions of me and what I'd done. I knew that, for many people, the amount of debt that I'd managed to accrue was shocking, and I had to learn to not let that make me feel ashamed. We each have our own experience with money and attitudes towards it, and we each value different things – understanding this can help us to both minimize our judgements of others, and increase our own resilience to external judgements that we might face. We all make judgements about other people's behaviour when it doesn't align with our own set of values or priorities, whether we notice that we're doing it or not. Remember that the next time that you worry about someone judging you.